

Ikea Sonos Symfonisk Lamp Speaker Gen 2

Upping the game and doubling down on the trend of making smart home gadgets look and feel like regular old furniture is Sonos in collaboration with Ikea. They recently announced the second generation of their table lamp smart speaker in the Symfonisk series featuring improvements in the acoustic architecture and a couple of newly redesigned lamp shades. The new acoustic architecture featuring a custom waveguide is touted to create an improved



sound experience from any angle and will of course be easy to integrate into an existing Sonos multi-room audio system. With the Gen 2 upgrade, the speaker will now also support a wider range of light bulbs with the

inclusion of the E26 / E27 socket. An important thing to note with the new Symfonisk speaker is that it won't be sold as an all in one package. The lamp base, priced at \$140 will be sold separately from the two lampshades they have on offer. The glass shade and the textile shade are priced at \$39 and \$29 respectively. The new Symfonisk lamp speaker fits in perfectly with the other products from the Symfonisk series like the Picture Frame speaker and bookshelf speaker.



Amazon Astro

Astro is Amazon's latest experiment with the smart home ecosystem. It is an amalgamation of Amazon's expertise in artificial intelligence, computer vision, voice recognition and sensor tech all in a package that looks like a hybrid between man's best friend and a Roomba. Astro can follow you around and play music or podcasts. It can even check in on others in the house remotely. It is one of Amazon's most ambitious projects, potentially making the smart home assistant ecosystem more interactive and with a more developed personality. Astro can move in 360 degrees using its 12-inch wheels, it has an array of sensors in the bezels of its screen face and a 5MP video calling camera. Ultrasonic sensors, time-of-flight cameras and other sensors are used by Astro to map out its environment somewhat like the aforementioned Roomba. There are of course some concerns regarding privacy as it can follow you around wherever you go in your home, but Amazon has included no-go zones that can be set up and most of the processing and data storage is done locally but a portion of data does get sent to Amazon's secure cloud.

The Little Car Company Aston Martin DB5 Junior

This is probably the ultimate tech toy you can get! With a limited run of just 125 units, this £90,000 (₹90,09,328) 66% scale replica of the Aston Martin DB5, one of the most iconic automobiles of all time, comes complete with a 16 kW motor producing 21.5 bhp capable of getting the model car to speeds in excess of 45 mph. The No Time To Die Edition (aka the fully loaded version) even comes with a bunch of gadgets that can be spotted on the James Bond car, like miniguns popping out from under the headlamps, Digital cycling number plates, and a hidden gadget switch pane. It also comes with a number of driving modes that make it a fun experience for drivers of all ages. This hand-crafted piece of engineering pays perfect homage



to Aston Martins of old, respecting the rich history of the brand, featuring classic Aston Martin badging, Silver Birch paintwork, instruments from Smiths, full leather interior, and a mahogany & aluminium steering wheel. Apart from harking back to bygone technology, The Little Car Company Aston Martin DB5 also features swappable lithium-ion battery packs and regenerative braking.